

FARIDABAD – THE URBAN DESTINATION

In 1607, the Mughal emperor, Jahangir's treasurer, Sheikh Farid, founded a qasbah comprising a fort, a water tank and a mosque. Named after him, Faridabad was set up to protect the emperor's newly-built highway. The same settlement was to become famous, when more than three hundred years later, the special Development Board of which Pandit Nehru was part, resettled nearly 16,000 people fleeing the North-west frontier provinces in large refugee camps in Faridabad.

It was 1949, but the settlers were enterprising and by the 1960s, the first wave of entrepreneurs including Eicher Tractors, Escorts and Lakhani had established businesses in Faridabad. Subsequently by the 1970s, Faridabad emerged as the most industrialized satellite of Delhi with 100 large and medium-scale units and 1000 small-scale units. Soon it grew so large that it was, at one time, dubbed Haryana's industrial capital. Under the energetic leadership of the Hooda administration, Faridabad has experienced a new resurgence. The modern wave of software development and IT enabled services and the prosperity it has brought in its wake has seen Faridabad change from a solidly industrial township to a city boasting all the modern amenities so sought after by today's younger generation. Large malls bursting with leading brands, the Metro, providing a boost to the transport system connecting Faridabad to its surrounding cities, luxury apartments featuring all modcons, restaurants, gyms and clubs are all part and parcel of daily life in Faridabad.

From being a mofussil town to being catapulted to the list of most dynamic cities in the country, Faridabad had managed to pull off a real feat in recent years.

Faridabad is growing, and that too, at a rapid pace. After years of suburban

